

0DTE nearest-OTM package: rule table by strategy, every intraday entry window

Rule table by strategy — entry 10:00 ET, one-bar hold

	n	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	t	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe _{ann} ^x
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	864	0.002	0.149	-1.12	0.25	-2.71	10.66	0.49	0.26	-3.74
sign(s) (± 1 on the sign of s)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	864	0.002	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.64	10.51	0.38	0.21	-3.88
block-diagonal ridge	864	0.002	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.63	10.51	0.46	0.25	-3.86
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	864	0.002	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.50	10.50	0.45	0.24	-3.86
LightGBM [†]	864	0.005	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.62	10.58	0.98	0.53	-3.61
XGBoost [†]	864	0.003	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.62	10.53	0.58	0.32	-3.80
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	864	-0.002	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.73	10.44	-0.36	-0.19	-4.25
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	864	0.002	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.64	10.51	0.38	0.21	-3.89
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	864	-0.003	0.149	-1.12	0.78	-0.73	10.42	-0.59	-0.32	-4.36

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 10:00 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 864 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck's frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 10:30 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe [×] _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	865	0.006	0.154	-1.96	0.21	-5.02	43.98	1.18	0.64	-2.44
sign(<i>s</i>) (± 1 on the sign of <i>s</i>)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	865	0.002	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.77	43.06	0.29	0.16	-2.97
block-diagonal ridge	865	0.003	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.76	43.10	0.50	0.27	-2.85
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	865	0.002	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.74	43.08	0.41	0.22	-2.91
LightGBM [†]	865	0.004	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.61	43.16	0.82	0.44	-2.68
XGBoost [†]	865	0.002	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.67	43.07	0.34	0.18	-2.94
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	865	-0.003	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.73	43.00	-0.56	-0.30	-3.41
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	865	0.004	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.77	43.14	0.68	0.37	-2.76
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	865	-0.002	0.154	-1.96	1.30	-0.76	43.00	-0.43	-0.23	-3.35

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 10:30 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 865 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 11:00 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe ^x _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	865	0.004	0.131	-1.27	0.21	-3.41	18.52	0.86	0.46	-3.21
<i>sign(s) (±1 on the sign of s)</i>										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	865	0.004	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.79	17.91	0.86	0.46	-3.29
block-diagonal ridge	865	0.002	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.62	17.99	0.50	0.27	-3.49
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	865	0.001	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.64	18.03	0.25	0.13	-3.63
LightGBM [†]	865	0.003	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.69	17.97	0.59	0.32	-3.45
XGBoost [†]	865	0.003	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.61	17.97	0.61	0.33	-3.43
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	865	0.003	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.73	17.94	0.73	0.39	-3.38
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	865	0.002	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.65	18.00	0.40	0.21	-3.55
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	865	0.003	0.131	-0.79	1.27	1.65	17.94	0.77	0.41	-3.35

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 11:00 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 865 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 11:30 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe [×] _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	865	0.016	0.114	-1.06	0.21	-3.37	19.30	4.05	2.19	-2.13
sign(<i>s</i>) (± 1 on the sign of <i>s</i>)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	865	0.003	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.04	16.63	0.66	0.36	-4.04
block-diagonal ridge	865	0.001	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.03	16.73	0.22	0.12	-4.27
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	865	-0.002	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.11	16.95	-0.50	-0.27	-4.66
LightGBM [†]	865	-0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.00	16.82	-0.09	-0.05	-4.44
XGBoost [†]	865	-0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.04	16.82	-0.10	-0.05	-4.44
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	865	0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.15	16.76	0.12	0.06	-4.33
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	865	-0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.05	16.80	-0.05	-0.03	-4.42
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	865	0.001	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.09	16.71	0.31	0.17	-4.23

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 11:30 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 865 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 12:00 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe [×] _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.008	0.112	-1.02	0.22	-3.16	17.88	2.09	1.12	-3.42
sign(<i>s</i>) (± 1 on the sign of <i>s</i>)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.000	0.112	-1.02	0.54	-1.19	16.81	0.03	0.01	-4.53
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.006	0.112	-1.02	0.84	-0.46	16.98	1.45	0.78	-3.81
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.006	0.112	-1.02	0.84	0.29	16.84	1.52	0.82	-3.78
LightGBM [†]	866	0.001	0.112	-1.02	0.54	-1.27	16.84	0.19	0.10	-4.43
XGBoost [†]	866	-0.000	0.112	-1.02	0.54	-1.25	16.79	-0.09	-0.05	-4.60
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.005	0.112	-1.02	0.84	0.27	16.84	1.44	0.77	-3.82
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.005	0.112	-1.02	0.84	-0.46	16.97	1.38	0.74	-3.85
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.005	0.112	-1.02	0.84	0.23	16.83	1.30	0.70	-3.91

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 12:00 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 12:30 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe [×] _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.013	0.115	-1.23	0.23	-3.74	25.06	3.29	1.78	-2.88
sign(<i>s</i>) (± 1 on the sign of <i>s</i>)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	-0.002	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.31	22.80	-0.41	-0.22	-4.86
block-diagonal ridge	866	-0.000	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.88	22.79	-0.11	-0.06	-4.70
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.001	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.82	22.82	0.15	0.08	-4.56
LightGBM [†]	866	0.001	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.22	22.82	0.25	0.13	-4.51
XGBoost [†]	866	-0.000	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.26	22.80	-0.07	-0.04	-4.68
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	-0.003	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.78	22.76	-0.65	-0.35	-4.99
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	-0.001	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.87	22.78	-0.27	-0.14	-4.78
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	-0.001	0.116	-1.23	0.78	-0.75	22.78	-0.30	-0.16	-4.79

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 12:30 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 13:00 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe ^x _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.002	0.168	-1.72	0.29	-4.23	29.08	0.43	0.23	-3.12
<i>sign(s) (±1 on the sign of s)</i>										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.010	0.168	-0.50	1.72	3.82	28.09	1.82	0.98	-2.43
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.010	0.168	-0.90	1.72	3.31	28.22	1.81	0.98	-2.43
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.013	0.168	-0.51	1.72	3.74	28.00	2.29	1.23	-2.18
LightGBM [†]	866	0.010	0.168	-0.51	1.72	3.79	28.13	1.70	0.92	-2.50
XGBoost [†]	866	0.012	0.168	-0.51	1.72	3.81	28.02	2.10	1.13	-2.29
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.011	0.168	-0.51	1.72	3.70	28.07	2.01	1.08	-2.33
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.014	0.168	-0.51	1.72	3.73	27.98	2.42	1.30	-2.11
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.010	0.168	-0.51	1.72	3.71	28.12	1.82	0.98	-2.43

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 13:00 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 13:30 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe [×] _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.008	0.161	-1.07	0.25	-2.85	11.71	1.46	0.79	-3.47
sign(<i>s</i>) (± 1 on the sign of <i>s</i>)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.004	0.161	-1.01	1.07	0.21	11.08	0.70	0.38	-4.00
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.008	0.161	-1.01	1.07	-0.25	11.19	1.47	0.80	-3.58
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.009	0.161	-1.01	1.07	0.14	11.12	1.56	0.84	-3.54
LightGBM [†]	866	0.001	0.161	-1.07	0.96	-0.34	11.10	0.24	0.13	-4.23
XGBoost [†]	866	-0.003	0.161	-1.07	0.96	-0.34	11.07	-0.50	-0.27	-4.62
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.005	0.161	-1.01	1.07	0.50	11.05	0.96	0.52	-3.86
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.009	0.161	-1.01	1.07	-0.18	11.21	1.74	0.94	-3.44
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.004	0.161	-1.07	0.96	-0.15	11.12	0.74	0.40	-3.96

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 13:30 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 14:00 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe [×] _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.008	0.237	-2.65	0.32	-4.48	32.87	0.93	0.50	-2.62
sign(<i>s</i>) (± 1 on the sign of <i>s</i>)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.002	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.64	32.29	0.20	0.11	-3.06
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.002	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.55	32.31	0.31	0.17	-3.00
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.000	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.52	32.24	0.02	0.01	-3.16
LightGBM [†]	866	-0.000	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.47	32.23	-0.02	-0.01	-3.19
XGBoost [†]	866	0.001	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.48	32.26	0.09	0.05	-3.13
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	-0.001	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.51	32.23	-0.06	-0.03	-3.20
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.002	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.54	32.29	0.21	0.12	-3.05
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	-0.001	0.237	-2.65	1.63	-1.51	32.21	-0.12	-0.07	-3.24

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 14:00 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 14:30 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe ^x _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.019	0.300	-5.15	0.38	-7.56	108.09	1.86	1.00	-1.52
<i>sign(s) (±1 on the sign of s)</i>										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.008	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.13	105.97	0.74	0.40	-2.15
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.009	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.43	106.17	0.88	0.48	-2.08
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.010	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.11	106.25	0.99	0.53	-2.02
LightGBM [†]	866	0.007	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.45	105.97	0.71	0.38	-2.17
XGBoost [†]	866	0.005	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.39	105.76	0.51	0.28	-2.28
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.009	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.42	106.13	0.85	0.46	-2.09
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.007	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.41	105.93	0.67	0.36	-2.19
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.007	0.300	-5.15	2.01	-5.41	105.94	0.68	0.37	-2.19

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 14:30 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 15:00 ET, one-bar hold

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe ^x _{ann}
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.060	0.379	-3.31	0.58	-3.03	15.14	4.64	2.51	0.18
<i>sign(s) (±1 on the sign of s)</i>										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.021	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-1.13	12.91	1.58	0.85	-1.43
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.030	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.94	13.04	2.28	1.23	-1.06
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.031	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.94	13.06	2.39	1.29	-1.00
LightGBM [†]	866	0.023	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-1.07	12.95	1.80	0.97	-1.31
XGBoost [†]	866	0.017	0.384	-3.31	2.85	-1.03	12.82	1.27	0.69	-1.59
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.031	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.80	13.02	2.39	1.29	-1.00
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.030	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.94	13.03	2.27	1.22	-1.07
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.027	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-1.18	13.06	2.11	1.14	-1.15

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 15:00 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — entry 15:30 ET, cash-settled at the close

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe _{ann} [×]
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.014	1.128	-10.32	1.00	-2.31	10.89	0.38	0.20	-0.26
sign(<i>s</i>) (± 1 on the sign of <i>s</i>)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.069	1.126	-5.42	10.32	0.58	10.71	1.79	0.97	0.50
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.095	1.124	-5.42	10.32	0.92	10.61	2.48	1.34	0.87
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.090	1.124	-5.42	10.32	1.00	10.59	2.36	1.27	0.80
LightGBM [†]	866	0.103	1.123	-5.42	10.32	1.01	10.58	2.71	1.46	0.99
XGBoost [†]	866	0.106	1.123	-5.42	10.32	0.91	10.62	2.78	1.50	1.03
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.100	1.123	-6.84	10.32	0.46	10.78	2.62	1.41	0.94
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.107	1.123	-5.42	10.32	1.22	10.50	2.80	1.51	1.04
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.072	1.125	-6.84	10.32	0.46	10.74	1.90	1.02	0.56

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 15:30 ET and let it cash-settle at the official close. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Rule table by strategy — pooled over the twelve entry windows

	<i>n</i>	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	<i>t</i>	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe _{ann} [×]
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.160	1.338	-11.40	2.24	-1.92	8.73	3.53	1.90	-1.92
<i>sign(s) (±1 on the sign of s)</i>										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.121	1.346	-5.96	11.40	0.27	7.23	2.64	1.43	-2.87
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.167	1.339	-6.26	11.40	0.55	7.53	3.68	1.99	-2.33
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.163	1.334	-6.26	11.40	0.59	7.57	3.59	1.94	-2.39
LightGBM [†]	866	0.158	1.341	-5.96	11.40	0.58	7.62	3.46	1.87	-2.44
XGBoost [†]	866	0.144	1.352	-5.96	11.40	0.47	7.45	3.14	1.69	-2.56
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.158	1.337	-7.03	11.40	0.30	7.98	3.47	1.87	-2.40
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.179	1.335	-6.26	10.65	0.60	6.45	3.96	2.13	-2.20
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.123	1.360	-7.03	11.40	0.26	7.79	2.67	1.44	-2.78

Each row is the daily sum over the twelve entry windows 10:00–15:30 ET: one number per expiration day, then the usual statistics on that daily series. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged.

Notes

One expiration day = one return; mid fill. Every t here is the plain $t = \sqrt{n} \cdot \text{mean}/\text{std}$, with no autocorrelation correction. “ex. kurt” is the bias-corrected sample excess kurtosis (Gaussian = 0). The short-volatility rule takes no forecast, so it is one row for all models. $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}} = (\text{mean}/\text{std}) \times \sqrt{252}$; every other column is daily. The one column this table adds to the deck’s is $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}}^{\times}$, the same rule’s annualized Sharpe at the *crossed spread* instead of the midpoint; every other column is the deck’s.

Forecasts: baseline (HAR + calendar OLS); block-diagonal ridge (HAR block and exogenous block, separate penalties) on the design carrying the FOMC calendar block, and the same ridge on the earlier design without those columns, as a diagnostic row; LightGBM and XGBoost on the all-features design; lasso on the same design, causally tuned vs. fixed $\alpha = 10^{-4}$; elastic net (causally tuned). † marks a column still fitted on the earlier design panel; a run of those four on the panel of record is pending. The signal is $s_t = \widehat{RV}_t - IV_{\text{hr}}^2 h_t w_t$: the forecast against the implied variance of the same window. On the bars whose vendor implied volatility is a censored solver node the deck’s treatment is used here too — the volatility that reproduces the package midpoint, recovered by bisection over the remaining h_t hours — so every bar carries a signal and no bar sits flat.